

WHERE TO START: BECOME AN AGENTIC AI ENGINEER

Learning Paths & Course Structure MCQs
70 Questions with Complete Answers & Explanations

Topic	Where to Start — Agentic AI Engineer Learning Paths
Total Questions	70 MCQs with Full Explanations
Format	Single Best Answer (A/B/C/D)
Coverage	Timelines, Modes, Courses 1-16, Pedagogical Approach

SECTION 1: Learning Path & Timeline

1. According to the learning path, how long does it take to become 'productive' with AI?

- A) 2 hours
- B) 6 hours
- C) 2 weeks
- D) 2 months

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Productive in about 6 hours. Foundations (Courses 1–2) plus your first mode course.

2. What is the timeline for shipping your first Digital FTE?

- A) A few days
- B) One week
- C) A weekend
- D) Two weeks

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Shipping your first Digital FTE in a weekend. Courses 7–9, end to end.

3. How long to become fluent across the full Agent Factory stack?

- A) One week
- B) A month of focused evenings
- C) Three months part-time
- D) Six months

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Fluent across full Agent Factory stack in a month of focused evenings. All 16 courses.

4. What is the core pedagogical philosophy?

- A) Learn every detail comprehensively
- B) Cover the critical 80%, start working, pick up rest through real use
- C) Focus only on theory
- D) Master one topic completely first

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Cover critical 80%, get you working, and let rest fill in through real use.

5. Why does 80/20 pedagogy work better than comprehensive learning upfront?

- A) It is cheaper
- B) Avoids burnout, gets you shipping instead of spending months learning
- C) Requires less reading
- D) Only available method

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Trying to learn every detail takes months. You would burn out before shipping.

SECTION 2: Mental Model & Three Layers

6. What are the three layers of work in the AI era?

- A) Hardware, software, firmware
- B) Models, data, compute
- C) Use general agents; build AI Workers; assemble into AI-Native Companies
- D) Frontend, backend, database

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Three layers: use general agents to solve problems; build AI Workers for jobs; assemble into AI-Native Companies.

7. What does every professional engagement start with?

- A) Building an AI Worker
- B) A human directing a general agent
- C) Assembling a company
- D) Writing specifications

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Every professional engagement starts the same way — a human directing a general agent.

8. How are Digital FTE, AI Worker, and AI Employee related?

- A) Three different types
- B) Same idea emphasizing different aspects — FTE (business), Worker (implementation), Employee (role)
- C) Digital FTE is outdated
- D) Completely unrelated

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Refer to same idea but emphasize business value, implementation, and role respectively.

SECTION 3: Mode 1 vs Mode 2

9. What is Mode 1 (Problem-Solving)?

- A) Building AI Workers
- B) Agent does the work; outcomes delivered directly to human
- C) Assembling companies
- D) Creating permanent infrastructure

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Mode 1: the agent does the work; in Mode 2 the agent builds a Worker.

10. What is Mode 2 (Manufacturing)?

- A) Solving daily problems
- B) Agent builds a Worker that does the work for you
- C) Buying pre-built tools
- D) Outsourcing work

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Mode 2: want to build AI that does the work for you. Agent builds the Worker.

11. Who should pick Mode 1?

- A) Only engineers
- B) Only business managers
- C) Anyone who wants AI to help them do work faster
- D) Only knowledge workers

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Mode 1 for anyone who wants AI to help do work faster — engineers or knowledge workers.

12. Who should pick Mode 2?

- A) Everyone
- B) Engineers or knowledge worker paired with engineer
- C) Only data scientists
- D) Only executives

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Mode 2 for: Engineers (or knowledge worker paired with an engineer).

13. What tool for Mode 1 engineers?

- A) Claude Cowork
- B) OpenWork
- C) Claude Code or OpenCode
- D) Paperclip

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Engineers in Mode 1 use Claude Code/OpenCode.

14. What tool for Mode 1 knowledge workers?

- A) Claude Code
- B) OpenCode
- C) Claude Cowork or OpenWork
- D) Paperclip

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Knowledge workers use Claude Cowork or OpenWork.

15. What governs Mode 1?

- A) Seven Invariants
- B) Seven Principles of Problem Solving
- C) Ten Commandments
- D) Paperclip rules

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Mode 1 governed by: Seven Principles of Problem Solving.

16. What governs Mode 2?

- A) Seven Principles
- B) Seven Invariants of the Agent Factory
- C) Seven Layers
- D) Charter

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Mode 2 governed by: Seven Invariants of the Agent Factory.

17. In Mode 2, what is general agent's output?

- A) Final outcome for humans
- B) The Worker that produces the outcome — not the outcome itself
- C) A specification
- D) A dataset

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: General agent's output is not the outcome — it is the Worker that produces it.

SECTION 4: Starter Paths

18. What should absolute beginner start with?

- A) Course 3
- B) Course 7
- C) Thesis → Course 1 → Course 2
- D) Any course

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Absolute beginner: Thesis → Course 1 (Prompting) → Course 2 (Thinking).

19. Starter path for knowledge worker?

- A) Thesis → Course 3 → Course 7
- B) Course 10 → Course 14
- C) Foundations → Course 4 → Course 5

D) Course 7-9

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Knowledge worker: Foundations (1–2) → Course 4 (Cowork) → Course 5 (Principles).

20. Starter path for engineer?

A) Foundations → Course 4 → Course 5

B) Foundations → Course 3 → Course 7 → Course 8

C) Course 10 → Course 14

D) Course 1 → Course 2

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Engineer: Foundations (1–2) → Course 3 → Course 7 → Course 8 (FTE).

21. Starter path for workforce builder?

A) Foundations → Course 4 → Course 5

B) Engineer path, then Course 10 → Course 13 → Course 14

C) Only Courses 10, 13, 14

D) Course 3 only

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Workforce builder: Engineer path, then Course 10 → Course 13 → Course 14.

22. First milestone for knowledge worker?

A) Workforce deployed

B) Evaluated agents

C) Ship real knowledge work with AI

D) First Digital FTE

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Knowledge worker milestone: Ship real knowledge work with AI.

23. First milestone for engineer?

A) Build Agents

B) Knowledge work

C) Ship your first Digital FTE

D) Cloud deployment

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Engineer milestone: Ship your first Digital FTE.

24. First milestone for workforce builder?

A) Real knowledge work

B) First Digital FTE

C) Governed AI workforce deployed to cloud

D) Learn prompting

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Workforce builder milestone: Governed AI workforce, deployed to the cloud.

25. Fastest path to shipped Digital FTE?

A) Foundations only

- B) Foundations → Course 3 → Course 7 → Course 8 → Course 13
- C) All 16 courses
- D) Courses 10-14

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Fastest: Foundations → Course 3 → 7 → 8 → 13 (Reader). About 12 hours.

SECTION 5: Course Timings

26. Time for Mode 1 (productive with AI)?

- A) 5 hours
- B) 12 hours
- C) 25 hours
- D) 45 hours

✓ **Correct Answer: A**

Explanation: Mode 1 (productive with AI) ~5h.

27. Time for Mode 2 minimum?

- A) 5 hours
- B) 12 hours
- C) 25 hours
- D) 45 hours

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Mode 2 minimum (first Digital FTE) ~12h.

28. Time for Mode 2 full?

- A) 5 hours
- B) 12 hours
- C) 25 hours
- D) 45 hours

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Mode 2 full (governed workforce) ~25h.

29. Time for full Agent Factory mastery?

- A) 25 hours
- B) 35 hours
- C) 45 hours
- D) 60 hours

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Full Agent Factory mastery ~45h (with cloud deployment course).

30. What is Course 1?

- A) Building Agents
- B) AI Prompting 2026 — 45-min primer on ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini
- C) Thinking in AI era
- D) Cloud deployment

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Course 1: AI Prompting in 2026 — 45-min, 13-concept primer.

SECTION 6: Foundations Courses

31. What is Course 2?

- A) Building agents
- B) Prompting
- C) How to Think in AI Era — cognitive discipline for real AI value
- D) Cloud deployment

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Course 2: How to Think in the AI Era — cognitive discipline for getting real value.

32. Who must complete Foundations?

- A) Only engineers
- B) Only knowledge workers
- C) Everyone before picking a mode
- D) Only executives

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Every reader takes Foundations (1-2) before picking a mode.

33. What is Course 3?

- A) 4-hour coding theory
- B) 90-min, 15-concept tour of Claude Code & OpenCode — for engineers
- C) Programming bootcamp
- D) Python basics

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Agentic Coding Crash Course: 90-min, 15-concept Claude Code/OpenCode tour.

SECTION 7: General Agents (Courses 3 & 4)

34. What is Course 4?

- A) Team collaboration
- B) 90-min, 15-concept Claude Cowork primer — for knowledge workers
- C) Project management
- D) Programming

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Cowork Crash Course: 90-min, 15-concept Claude Cowork primer for knowledge workers.

35. What is Course 5?

- A) 4-hour strategy
- B) 90-min, 7-principle operating discipline for any general agent
- C) Math problems
- D) Business course

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Problem Solving: 90-min, 7-principle operating discipline for general agents.

SECTION 8: Mode 1 Courses (Courses 5 & 6)

36. What are the seven principles in Course 5?

- A) Hire, Assign, Govern, Observe, Retire, Expand, Execute
- B) Bash as key, code as interface, verification, decomposition, persistence, constraints, observability
- C) Plan, Design, Build, Test, Deploy, Monitor, Improve
- D) Model, Data, Compute, Storage, Network, Security, Compliance

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Seven principles: Bash, Code, Verification, Decomposition, Persistence, Constraints, Observability.

37. What is the four-phase workflow in Course 5?

- A) Hire, Assign, Execute, Retire
- B) Design, Build, Test, Deploy
- C) Explore, Plan, Implement, Commit
- D) Ideate, Prototype, Test, Launch

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Four-phase workflow: Explore, Plan, Implement, Commit.

38. What is Course 6?

- A) 90-min cryptography
- B) 90-min, 6-scenario installing Personal AI Employee on OpenClaw
- C) Cloud deployment
- D) Payment systems

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: OpenClaw with General Agents: 90-min, 6-scenario hands-on course.

39. What does Course 6 cover?

- A) Just install
- B) Custom skill, MCP tool, heartbeat task, ACP-spawn demo
- C) Train on data
- D) Sell it

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Covers: custom skill, MCP tool, heartbeat task, ACP-spawn demo.

40. How many moves in manufacturing path?

- A) 5
- B) 7
- C) 10
- D) 12

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Manufacturing path: 7 moves — build, promote, connect, manage, hire, free, prove with evals.

SECTION 9: Mode 2 Manufacturing (Courses 7-14)

41. What is Course 7?

- A) 40-hour comprehensive
- B) 90-min, 16-concept OpenAI Agents SDK primer
- C) Build from scratch
- D) Machine learning

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Build AI Agents: 90-min, 16-concept OpenAI Agents SDK primer.

42. Prerequisite for Course 7?

- A) None
- B) Course 1
- C) Course 3
- D) All Foundations

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Prereq: Course 3 (Claude Code).

43. What is Course 8?

- A) 90 minutes
- B) 4-hour workshop on turning agent into durable Worker
- C) Hiring employees
- D) Business strategy

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: From Agent to Digital FTE: 4-hour workshop on building durable Workers.

44. Learning paths in Course 8?

- A) One path
- B) Quick Win (15 min), Cheat-sheet (90 min), Full build (3+ hours)
- C) 40-hour only
- D) Videos only

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Three paths: Quick Win (15 min), Cheat-sheet (90 min), Full build (3+ hours).

45. What is Course 9?

- A) 4 hours
- B) 90-min on wrapping Worker in Inngest operational envelope
- C) Employee management
- D) Networking

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: From Digital FTE to Production Worker: 90-min on Inngest envelope.

46. Concepts in Course 9?

- A) Basic building
- B) Durability, events, memoization, concurrency, replay, HITL gates

- C) Cloud only
- D) Team management

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Covers: durable execution, events, memoization, concurrency, replay, HITL.

47. What is Course 10?

- A) 90-min document management
- B) 90-min, 6-scenario Paperclip hands-on course
- C) Theory
- D) HR

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Building Workforce with Paperclip: 90-min, 6-scenario hands-on.

48. What do Course 10 scenarios cover?

- A) Theory only
- B) Hiring, approvals, swapping Workers, SQL queries on history
- C) Just setup
- D) Just reading

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Scenarios: hire Workers, board approvals, swap Workers, SQL history queries.

49. What is Course 11?

- A) 90 minutes
- B) Half-day, 15-concept, 7-decision on dynamic workforce
- C) Full day
- D) Month-long

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: From Fixed to Dynamic: half-day, 15-concept, 7-decision workshop.

50. What does Course 11 teach?

- A) Manual hiring
- B) Detect gaps, provision dynamically — hiring as callable function
- C) Static workforce
- D) Human employees

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Teaches: detect capability gaps, provision dynamically, hiring as callable function.

51. What is Course 12?

- A) 90 minutes
- B) Half-day on Owner Identic AI handling approvals
- C) Week-long
- D) Just video

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: From Founder Bottleneck: half-day on Owner Identic AI.

52. Problem Course 12 solves?

- A) Slow review
- B) Owner bottleneck — Identic AI clears routine approvals
- C) Team communication
- D) Infrastructure cost

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Solves: Owner bottleneck via Identic AI handling routine approvals.

53. What is Course 13?

- A) 90 minutes
- B) Four tracks — Reader, Beginner, Intermediate, Advanced
- C) Just theory
- D) Data scientists only

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Eval-Driven Development: four tracks from Reader (3-4h) to Advanced (3 days).

54. Nine-layer pyramid in Course 13?

- A) Random
- B) Unit, integration, output, tool-use, trace, RAG, safety, regression, production
- C) Basic testing
- D) No structure

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Nine-layer pyramid: unit, integration, output, tool-use, trace, RAG, safety, regression, production.

55. Tools for Course 13 evals?

- A) Manual only
- B) OpenAI Evals, DeepEval, Ragas, Phoenix
- C) No tools
- D) Paid enterprise only

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Four-tool stack: OpenAI Agent Evals, DeepEval, Ragas, Phoenix.

56. Weekly ritual in Course 13?

- A) Daily check
- B) Trace-to-regression-test promotion keeps suite alive
- C) Onboarding only
- D) Not mentioned

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Weekly trace-to-regression-test promotion keeps eval suite alive over months.

57. What is Course 14?

- A) 90 minutes
- B) Ships everything — teaches harness/sandbox split
- C) Just reading
- D) Only theory

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Deploy Agent Harness: ships all manufacturing track work with harness/sandbox.

58. Production path in Course 14?

- A) AWS only
- B) FastAPI + Azure, Postgres, Cloudflare R2, sandbox, observability
- C) Docker/Kubernetes
- D) Just theory

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Path: FastAPI on Azure, Neon Postgres, Cloudflare R2, sandbox, four-surface observability.

59. What is Course 15?

- A) Problem-solving discipline
- B) Choosing Agentic Architectures — pattern selection by fit
- C) Payment processing
- D) Team management

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Choosing Agentic Architectures: five questions map to one of four patterns.

SECTION 10: Advanced Courses (15 & 16)

60. How many core patterns in Course 15?

- A) Two
- B) Three
- C) Four
- D) Seven

✓ **Correct Answer: C**

Explanation: Four core patterns: sequential workflow, single agent+ReAct+tools, planning+execution, multi-agent.

61. What is Course 16?

- A) Deployment only
- B) Payment-Enabled Agents: ACP, AP2, x402, MPP protocols
- C) Theory course
- D) Learning paths

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Payment-Enabled Agents: four protocols for agents moving money.

62. What are the four payment protocols?

- A) API, SDK, HTTP, REST
- B) ACP, AP2, x402, MPP
- C) Stripe, PayPal, Square, Adyen
- D) Credit, Debit, Check, Cash

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Four protocols: ACP (consumer), AP2 (mandates), x402 (HTTP payments), MPP (micropayments).

63. What do the four payment layers represent?

- A) Hardware levels
- B) Discovery, authorization, commerce, settlement
- C) Time periods
- D) User types

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Four layers: discovery, authorization, commerce, settlement.

64. What is available after the courses?

- A) Nothing else
- B) References, Cheatsheets, Fundamentals, Glossary
- C) Paid premium content
- D) Community forums only

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: References: Which AI Employees, Cheatsheets, Fundamentals, Glossary.

SECTION 11: Book Resources & References

65. What do the cheatsheets cover?

- A) Theory only
- B) Interactive quick-reference for Claude Code, Cowork, OpenClaw
- C) All 16 courses
- D) Payment protocols only

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Cheatsheets: interactive cards for Claude Code, Cowork, OpenClaw.

66. What is Agentic Engineering Fundamentals?

- A) Required for everyone
- B) 45-minute primer on design, shipping, operating agent systems
- C) Only for engineers
- D) Advanced course

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: 45-minute primer on engineering discipline for agent-based systems.

67. What will you NOT have after this section?

- A) Worked Digital FTE
- B) Notes and theory
- C) Working AI workforce
- D) Personal Identical AI

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: You finish with working workforce, not just notes.

SECTION 12: Learning Outcomes & What You'll Build

68. What is the key difference from other AI courses?

- A) More videos
- B) You finish with working AI workforce, not notes
- C) Lower cost
- D) Easier material

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Difference: you finish with working AI workforce, not theory.

69. How are the chapters used after course?

- A) Archived
- B) Reference to reach for when stuck in real work
- C) Optional reading
- D) One-time use

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: Chapters are reference you reach for whenever stuck in real work.

70. What do you learn in the complete path?

- A) Theory only
- B) Used general agents, deployed Digital FTE, connected nervous system, workforce hired itself, freed yourself, proven trustworthy with evals
- C) Just one Digital FTE
- D) Concepts without implementation

✓ **Correct Answer: B**

Explanation: You: used general agents, deployed FTE, connected nervous system, workforce hires itself, freed yourself with Identic AI, wrapped in evals.

QUICK REFERENCE ANSWER KEY

Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A
1	B	2	C	3	B	4	B	5	B
6	C	7	B	8	B	9	B	10	B
11	C	12	B	13	C	14	C	15	B
16	B	17	B	18	C	19	C	20	B
21	B	22	C	23	C	24	C	25	B
26	A	27	B	28	C	29	C	30	B
31	C	32	C	33	B	34	B	35	B
36	B	37	C	38	B	39	B	40	B
41	B	42	C	43	B	44	B	45	B
46	B	47	B	48	B	49	B	50	B
51	B	52	B	53	B	54	B	55	B
56	B	57	B	58	B	59	B	60	C
61	B	62	B	63	B	64	B	65	B
66	B	67	B	68	B	69	B	70	B

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